Haul Monitor — Trimble PC*MILER Pricing Analysis

Prepared for: Trimble Partnership Meeting **Date:** March 19, 2026 **Prepared by:** Haul Monitor

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1. Trimble Proposed Pricing (As Submitted)

Term	Detail
Per-load rate	$0.30 per posted load / per month
Monthly minimum (months 1–6)	$250/month
Monthly minimum (month 7+ / renewals)	$500/month
Reporting obligation	Load count submitted by the 10th of each month
Billing	Credit card for first 6 months; optional Net-30 thereafter

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2. Why "Posted Load" Doesn't Fit Haul Monitor's Model

Haul Monitor is **not a load board**. We do not originate or post freight.

Our model: dispatchers connect their existing load board accounts (DAT, Truckstop, etc.) and Haul Monitor aggregates available loads from those boards, runs them through PC*MILER's routing engine, and surfaces the best backhaul matches for their route home. The loads already exist elsewhere — we are the intelligence layer on top of them.

This means:

- We have no "posted loads" to count
- Charging us per load in our system would mean paying for inventory we don't own
- At scale, a single popular backhaul lane could have the same load evaluated by hundreds of our users — it should not count as hundreds of billable events

The right pricing unit for an aggregator is the downstream action: a dispatcher selecting a load to haul.

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3. Proposed Counter-Model: Per Load Selected

The "Haul This Load" Event

Haul Monitor has a built-in confirmation workflow called **"Haul This Load."** When a dispatcher finds a match they want to pursue, they click the button, review the route/financials in a confirmation dialog, and confirm. That event:

- Writes a timestamped record to our database (`completed_at`, `status: completed`, `revenue_amount`, `net_revenue`)

- Is discrete, auditable, and non-gameable — a dispatcher only clicks it when they are genuinely taking the load
- Is exactly the moment PC*MILER's routing intelligence delivered value

This is the event we propose as the billable unit.

Why This Works for Both Parties

	Per Posted Load (Trimble's Proposal)	**Per Load Selected (Haul Monitor Counter)**
Fits Haul Monitor's model	No — we don't post loads	Yes — we track selections natively
Auditable	Requires defining what "in system" means	Yes — timestamped DB record per event
Tied to PC*MILER value delivery	Loosely	Directly — selection follows a PC*MILER match
Fair at scale	No — same load seen by 1,000 users = 1,000 charges	Yes — one charge per dispatcher action
Predictable for Trimble	Variable	Consistent with platform growth

4. Market Basis (TAM)

Segment	**Count**	**Source**
Specialized truck dispatchers (core)	38,000–40,000	Bureau of Labor Statistics
Dedicated truck dispatchers (expanded)	~196,000	Industry estimates
Broader transport/logistics/dispatch roles	200,000+	BLS (related fields)

Working TAM: 39,000 (core/conservative) and 196,000 (expanded)

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5. Usage Model — Searches vs. Selections

The key distinction in Haul Monitor's workflow is the large gap between loads *evaluated* and loads *selected*.

Parameter	**Assumption**	**Rationale**
Searches per dispatcher per day	10	Active dispatchers managing multiple trucks
Loads evaluated per search	25	Current match cap
Total loads seen per day	250	Before filtering and selection
Loads actually hauled per day	2–5	Realistic for a dispatcher managing a small fleet
Conversion rate (seen → hauled)	**~1–2%**	Dispatcher evaluates many options, commits to few

Parameter	Assumption	Rationale
Hauls per user per month	**~50–110**	22 working days

Working baseline for cost modeling: 50 "Haul This Load" events per active user per month (conservative).

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6. Cost Projections — Per Load Selected at $0.30

Platform Scale	Active Users	Hauls/User/Mo	Monthly Hauls	Monthly Cost	Annual Cost
Early (pre-launch)	<10	50	<500	**$250** (minimum)	$3,000
Seed growth	~50	50	2,500	**$750**	$9,000
1% core TAM	~390	50	19,500	**$5,850**	$70,200
5% core TAM	~1,950	50	97,500	**$29,250**	$351,000
10% core TAM	~3,900	50	195,000	**$58,500**	$702,000
5% expanded TAM	~9,800	50	490,000	**$147,000**	$1.76M

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7. Haul Monitor Pricing Model — Credits, Not Subscriptions

Haul Monitor uses a **pay-per-search credit model**. No monthly subscription. Credits never expire.

Bundle	Price	Credits	Cost Per Credit	Savings vs. Starter
Starter	$50	10	**$5.00/credit**	—
Pro *(most popular)*	$75	30	**$2.50/credit**	50%
Fleet	$200	100	**$2.00/credit**	60%

What costs 1 credit:

- Creating and running a backhaul search
- Material change re-run on an open, active backhaul request
- Creating and running an estimate request

Credit Consumption Per Active User Per Month

Usage Level	Searches/Day	Credits/Month	Likely Bundle
Light	1	~22	Starter (×2) or Pro
Moderate	2–3	~50–65	Pro (×2) or Fleet

Usage Level	Searches/Day	Credits/Month	Likely Bundle
Heavy	5	~110	Fleet + top-up

Baseline for modeling: 50 credits/user/month (moderate user, roughly one Pro bundle per month).

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8. Revenue Margin Implications — Credits vs. Trimble Cost

Revenue Per Credit (by bundle)

Bundle	Revenue/Credit	Trimble Cost/Credit*	Gross Margin
Starter	$5.00	$0.03–$0.30	**94–99%**
Pro	$2.50	$0.03–$0.30	**88–99%**
Fleet	$2.00	$0.03–$0.30	**85–99%**

Trimble cost per credit = $0.30 per haul selected ÷ estimated 1–10 searches per haul conversion rate.

Conversion rate drives Trimble cost: a dispatcher runs multiple searches before committing to a load. At 10% conversion (1 haul per 10 searches), Trimble costs $0.03/credit. At 100% (every search results in a haul), it's $0.30/credit — still only 6–15% of revenue.

Monthly Revenue at Scale (50 credits/user/month, Pro-tier blended at $2.50/credit)

Scenario	Users	Credits/Month	Monthly Revenue	Trimble Cost	Gross Margin
1% core TAM	390	19,500	$48,750	$5,850	**$42,900 (88%)**
5% core TAM	1,950	97,500	$243,750	$29,250	**$214,500 (88%)**
10% core TAM	3,900	195,000	$487,500	$58,500	**$429,000 (88%)**
5% expanded TAM	9,800	490,000	$1,225,000	$147,000	**$1,078,000 (88%)**

> Margins hold consistently at ~88% across all scale scenarios at the Pro tier. The credit model is well-structured: Trimble's cost scales with usage, and our revenue scales with the same usage. There is no margin compression at growth.

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9. Three-Way Pricing Model Comparison

Trimble has proposed "per posted load" pricing and may counter with "per load evaluated." Here is how all three models compare at the same usage baseline.

Usage Baseline (Per Active User, Per Month)

Parameter	Value

Parameter	Value
Searches/day	10
Session cache hit rate	60% → 4 fresh searches/day
DB cache hit rate (at scale)	~70% leg-level reduction on session misses
Loads evaluated per fresh search	25
Loads evaluated/month	**4 × 25 × 22 days = 2,200**
Effective API calls/month (no DB cache)	**~4,400**
Effective API calls/month (with DB cache, at scale)	**~1,320**
Loads actually selected (hauled)/month	**50** (1–2% conversion)

Model A — Per Load Evaluated (Trimble likely counter)

Every load run through PC*MILER in a search counts as a billable event.

Scenario	Users	Loads Evaluated/Month	Monthly Cost @ $0.30	Annual Cost
Early	~10	22,000	**$6,600**	$79,200
1% core TAM	390	858,000	**$257,400**	$3.1M
5% core TAM	1,950	4,290,000	**$1,287,000**	$15.4M

> **This model is a non-starter for Haul Monitor.** At just 1% TAM penetration, it costs more per month than our entire expected annual revenue. It penalizes the intelligence layer — the more thoroughly we search on a dispatcher's behalf, the more we pay.
>
> Note: even if Trimble defines "evaluated" as API calls rather than candidate loads, our DB-backed shared distance cache (now implemented) reduces effective API volume by ~70% at scale — but the numbers are still unworkable at any meaningful penetration.

Model B — Per Load Selected / "Haul This Load" (Haul Monitor proposal)

Only counts when a dispatcher confirms they are taking a load.

Scenario	Users	Loads Selected/Month	Monthly Cost @ $0.30	Annual Cost
Early	~10	500	**$150** (under minimum)	$1,800
1% core TAM	390	19,500	**$5,850**	$70,200
5% core TAM	1,950	97,500	**$29,250**	$351,000
10% core TAM	3,900	195,000	**$58,500**	$702,000

> **Fair and sustainable.** Scales with actual value delivered. Auditable via timestamped database record on dispatcher confirmation.

Model C — Per Posted Load (Trimble's original proposal)

Not applicable to Haul Monitor — we are an aggregator and do not originate or post loads. See Section 2.

Side-by-Side Cost Comparison at 5% Core TAM (~1,950 users)

Pricing Model	Monthly Cost	Annual Cost	Viable?
Per load evaluated @ $0.30	$1,287,000	$15.4M	No
Per load selected @ $0.30	$29,250	$351,000	Yes
Difference	**44× higher**	**44× higher**	—

The evaluation-to-selection ratio is ~44:1. A per-evaluated-load rate would need to be priced at roughly $0.007 or less to be cost-equivalent to a $0.30 per-selected-load model. That is the number to put on the table if Trimble insists on an evaluation-based unit.

DB Cache Impact on Underlying API Volume

A shared DB-backed distance cache (now implemented — `route_distance_cache` table) reduces raw PC*MILER API calls independent of pricing model. This is relevant context if Trimble is pricing against actual API consumption.

Cache State	API Calls/User/Month	Reduction
Session cache only (prior baseline)	~4,400	—
+ DB cache, early (warming)	~3,000–3,500	20–30%
+ DB cache, at scale (6+ months)	**~1,320**	**~70%**

Why ~70% at scale:

- `delivery→home` leg: ~95% hit rate — fleet home is fixed, all delivery cities cache quickly
- `pickup→delivery` leg: ~65% hit rate — popular freight lanes repeat across users platform-wide
- `datum→pickup` leg: ~50% hit rate — datum varies per search, partially cacheable for fixed terminals

Even at 70% API reduction, per-evaluated-load pricing remains unworkable. The per-selected-load model is the only viable structure.

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10. Key Questions / Negotiating Points

1. **Hold the line on "per load selected"** — If Trimble counters with per-load-evaluated pricing, the rate would need to be ~$0.007 or less to be cost-equivalent. Present the 44:1 ratio directly.
2. **If they insist on evaluation-based pricing** — propose a per-search rate instead of per-load-evaluated. One search = one credit = one billing event, regardless of how many loads are evaluated inside it. Cleaner, and ~25× more favorable than per-load-evaluated.

3. **Get the tier breakpoints** — At what monthly volume do rates drop, and to what? Applies to either model.
4. **Confirm what's auditable** — We can export monthly haul counts (or search counts) from our database by the 10th of each month, with timestamps. Ask what format Trimble requires.
5. **API rate limits** — We generate bursts of up to 50 parallelized calls per search. Confirm no burst throttling.
6. **Relay loads** — Our relay mode evaluates a different route geometry. Do relay hauls/searches count the same?
7. **Lock in the rate** — Negotiate the right to move to lower tiers as volume grows without renegotiating the full agreement.
8. **Multi-board deduplication** — If the same load appears on DAT and Truckstop, a single "Haul This Load" event fires once. One billable event, not two.

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11. Summary

Trimble's proposed unit	Per posted load/month
Haul Monitor's proposed unit	**Per load selected ("Haul This Load" event)**
Why the change	Haul Monitor is an aggregator — we don't post loads
Tracking mechanism	Built — timestamped DB record on dispatcher confirmation
Haul Monitor pricing	Credit bundles: $50/10 credits · $75/30 credits · $200/100 credits
Revenue per credit (Pro)	$2.50
Minimum cost	$250/mo (yr 1), $500/mo (yr 2+)
Trimble cost per credit	$0.03–$0.30 (varies by search-to-haul conversion rate)
Gross margin after Trimble	~88% at Pro tier, across all scale scenarios
API calls per haul selected	~88 (demonstrates value of outcome-based pricing)
Verdict	Credit model + per-selection Trimble pricing = consistent ~88% margins at every scale

Assumptions: 22 working days/month, 10 searches/dispatcher/day, 40% cache miss rate, 25 load candidates/search, 2 Route Report calls/load, 50 "Haul This Load" events/user/month.